

in this pursuit, because both my priorities *and* my methods were off, which only served to further complicate and erode my relationship with money.

For the first ten years after I started managing my own money, I was very disconnected from my finances. I saw money only as a means to an end, and had a very distorted view of the value that things held. For some reason I really struggled to connect my actions with money to the way that I felt about it, and the anxiety and despondency that not having enough of it were causing me. I was stuck in cycles of behaviour that I knew were hurting me, damaging my chances at a secure future, and making me feel more and more ashamed and alone, but I didn't know how to break out of them. Every now and again I would try to apply my logical brain to my messy financial accounts, but real life would get in the way, and I didn't know how to reconcile the two. It took a rude awakening and brutal honesty, followed by a lot of reflection and work, to sort it out, but I got there in the end.

That is what I want you to get from this book. The tools, knowledge and support that you need to create some harmony between your brain and your bank balance, without having to conform to someone else's idea of what it means to be 'good with money'. To bridge that engagement gap between what you know and what you feel, and to help you to acknowledge, then challenge, the behaviours that are keeping you stuck in a toxic relationship with money.